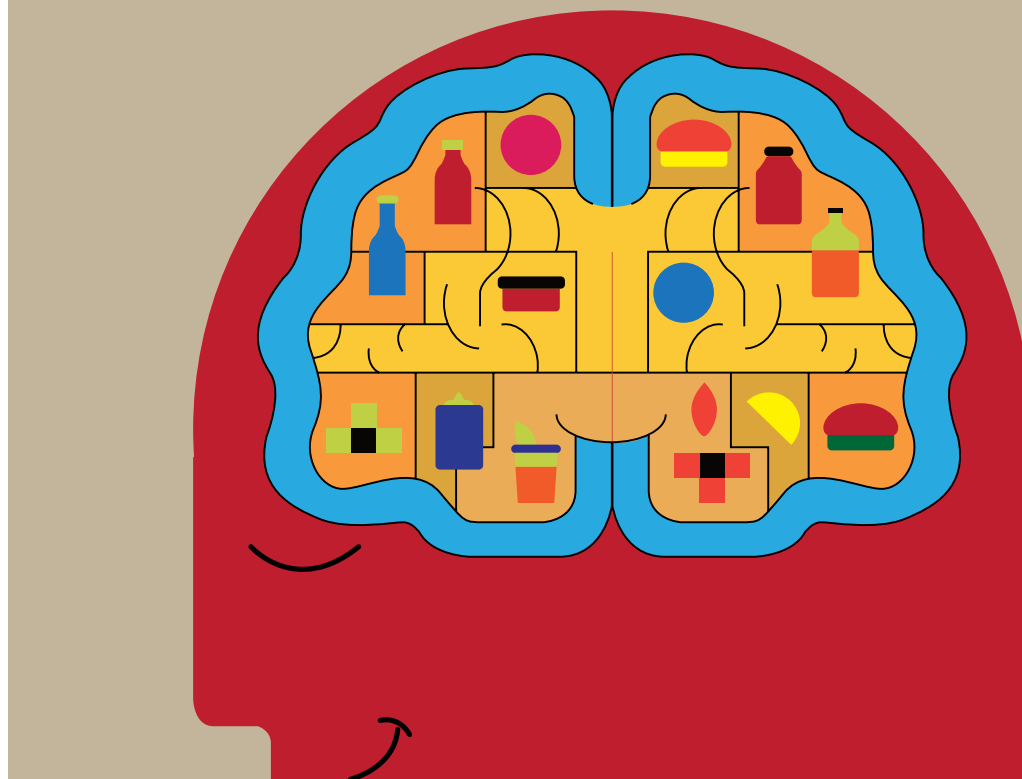




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vigilant about the products they consume and are placing greater trust in established brands with strong reputation for food safety.

People today want quality. They don't just eat anything that you put on the table. During my market travel, a retailer told me that our brand stands out because of high quality. Consumers say, I can pay more, but I know I get unimpeachable quality and refuse to be bamboozled into anything short of that!

Brands are increasingly adopting premiumisation and value-up opportunities, attaching high perceived value to their products to attract discerning consumers.

There is a growing emphasis on purchasing products with enhanced nutritional profiles, millet-based innovations and fortified products. Brands would need to expand the nutritional profile of their portfolio.

Sustainability has emerged as a

key driver of consumer choice. Consumers are increasingly seeking companies committed to environmental and social responsibility.

The Power of 'Now'

Quick commerce has taken the Indian grocery market by storm, with a significant portion of urban consumers now relying on it for their primary shopping needs. This surge in quick commerce adoption highlights the growing demand for convenience and speed among Indian consumers.

According to a recent NIQ shopper trends report, a staggering 31% of urban Indians now use quick commerce platforms for their primary grocery shopping, while another 39% use them for top-up purchases.

Integration of AI will continue to redefine consumer engagement, by accelerating innovation and launching new products at a

higher speed. However, I would urge careful consideration in the deployment of AI for predictive analysis, strategic planning mechanism, and information dissemination. AI should be used to enhance human capabilities and serve humanity rather than allowing them to dictate its course.

I believe relying on facts and evidence takes precedence, simply stating something isn't enough. Use of data and analytics tools, such as Nestlé's MIDAS and NesMitra, when combined with insights of local shopkeepers, distributors and consumers, is a powerful tool to serve consumers.

Therefore, there is a need to combine AI with real intelligence and work on the ground, through activation, sampling, getting people to try more products and this should be an intrinsic part of the journey. **BT**

Views are personal